

Study cohort



Eligible OpenAlex journal articles

Published 2015–2020

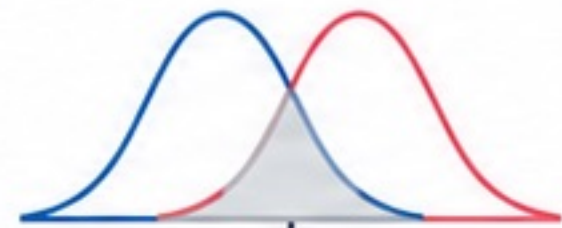
Original articles · titles available ·
60-month follow-up possible

Comparable analysis sample

● **How journal scope was measured**
Each journal's titles from $t-3$ to $t-1$
SPECTER2 · mean title similarity
higher similarity = narrower scope

Same title-based topic and publication year

1,000 SPECTER2 topics × year



3.82M papers retained

with comparable measured characteristics
paper · author · institution · journal history
LightGBM publication model; weighting + outcome models

60-month citation follow-up

Publication (t_0)
classified by journal scope



**broader-scope
journals**

60 months



middle 50%
not analyzed



**narrower-scope
journals**

60 months



Primary outcome
**Cross-area citations
relative to same-topic
citations**

other-area / same-topic
*where citations accumulated,
not only how many*

Where did each citation come from?

Qwen3 title map: 1,000 topics within 32 research areas
No journal names used

- same topic
- different topic, same research area
- different research area
- unclassified

Middle 50% excluded from the primary comparison; 3.82M papers retained after restricting to comparable measured characteristics.